

PAOLA GALANO TORO

Email ◇ Website ◇ LinkedIn

EMPLOYMENT

Visiting Professor in Political Science	Madrid, Spain
Social Sciences Department-Institute Juan Linz, Universidad Carlos III de Madrid	01/2025 - 01/2027
Postdoctoral Fellow	Zurich, Switzerland
Department of Humanities, Social and Political Sciences, ETH Zurich	04/2024 - 12/2024

EDUCATION

PhD in Political Science	Zurich, Switzerland
Department of Humanities, Social and Political Sciences, ETH Zurich	10/2019 - 03/2024
- Thesis title: Whose state, whose nation? Explaining Uneven State Capacity in Latin America - Committee: Prof. Lars-Erik Cederman (ETH), Dr. Manuel Vogt (UCL), Prof. Miguel Angel Centeno (Princeton)	
MA Comparative and International Studies	Zurich, Switzerland
Department of Humanities, Social and Political Sciences, ETH Zurich	09/2017 - 09/2019
BA Philosophy, Politics and Economics	Lucerne, Switzerland
Faculty of Humanities and Social Sciences, University of Lucerne	09/2014 - 06/2017

VISITING APPOINTMENTS

Visiting Scholar	Montreal, QB, Canada
Department of Political Science, McGill University	09/2026 - 12/2026
Visiting PhD Student	London, UK
Department of Political Science, University College London	04/2022 - 07/2022

PUBLICATIONS

- **War Did Make States: Revisiting the Bellicist Paradigm in Early Modern Europe.** *International Organisation*, Spring 2023, 77(2): 324-362 (with Lars-Erik Cederman, Guy Schvitz and Luc Girardin.)
- **The Return of Nationalist Geopolitics: Liberal Backsliding and Conflict.** *International Security*, Summer 2026, 51(1): 80-122 (with Lars-Erik Cederman, Luc Girardin, Andreas Juon, and Julian Wucherpennig)
- **La Prusia de Latinoamérica: construcción el estado y guerra en Chile del siglo XIX** (Accepted for publication as part of Special Issue at *América Latina Hoy*)

WORK UNDER REVIEW OR IN PREPARATION

- **The Prussia of Latin America: state-, nation-building and war in nineteenth century Chile** (Review & Resubmit as part of Special Issue at *Journal of Latin American Studies*)
- **Ethnic Threats and the Making of Nation and State on the Frontier** (with Christopher L. Carter, Jorge Mangonnet, and Federico Lombisano) (under review at *American Political Science Review*)
- **Edited Volume: The Evolution of Violence in Latin America** (with Raul L. Madrid and Luis L. Schenoni) (under review at *Cambridge University Press*)
 - **Introduction** (with Raul L. Madrid and Luis L. Schenoni)
 - **Rebels Then and Now: Two Centuries of Popular Uprisings in Latin America.** (Chapter 5, also in preparation for submission as a journal article to *Civil Wars* or *Journal of Peace Research*)
 - **Conclusion** (with Luis L. Schenoni and Raul L. Madrid)
- **Engines of Progress: Nation-building and Railroad Construction in Latin America** (submitted to *Comparative Political Studies*, potential outlets: *LAPS*, *Comparative Politics*)
- **Conflict and nation: The colonial origins of ethnic exclusion and discrimination in Latin America** (with Luis Schenoni and Raul L. Madrid) (potential outlets: *JLAS*, *Nations and Nationalism* and *Comparative Politics*)
- **Rethinking Rebellion: A Conceptual Introduction to the Latin American Revolts Dataset** (with Raul L. Madrid and Luis Schenoni) (potential outlets: *JPR* or *ISQ*)

SELECTED WORK IN PROGRESS

- **Building States on Paper: Constitutional Proliferation and Capacity Failure in Latin America** (with Gabriel Negretto)
- **Boundaries of Bargaining: Repúblicas de Indios, Ethnic Mobilization, and Spatial Inequality in Public Goods Provision**
- **Book manuscript: Whose state, whose nation? Explaining Uneven State Capacity in Latin America**

DATASETS

- **The Latin American Revolts Database (LARD) (1830-2024)** *Harvard Dataverse* <https://doi.org/10.7910/DVN/YWKE7F> (with Raul L. Madrid and Luis Schenoni)

CONFERENCES AND PRESENTATIONS

- **2026:** LASA, EPSS, APSA, Interdisciplinary Workshop on Comparative Politics (UMichigan) (invited), CEIPS (University of Montreal) (invited)
- **2025:** SPSA, Junior HPE Workshop (UC3M), APSA, Lozano-Long Conference (UT Austin) (conference co-organizer), Madrid Empirical Social Sciences (MESS) Conference
- **2024:** APSA, Legacies Workshop (NTNU) (invited)
- **2023:** Annual Conflict and Change Conference (UCL), EPSA, APSA
- **2022:** American Historical Association (AHA), APSA
- **2021:** Poster session at APSA
- **2020:** Annual Conflict and Change Conference (UCL)

TEACHING AND MENTORING EXPERIENCE

Graduate Seminar: International Relations	Madrid, Spain
University Carlos III of Madrid (<i>Evaluation Grade (EG): 5 out of 5</i>)	Spring Term 2026
Undergraduate Lecture and Seminar: World Politics	Madrid, Spain
University Carlos III of Madrid (<i>EG: average 4.61 out of 5 (2025), 4.65 out of 5 (2026)</i>)	Spring Term 2025 and 2026
Guest lecture: Ethnic conflict and state development in Latin America (in Spanish)	Lima, Peru (online)
Pontificia Universidad Católica del Peru	March 2024
Guest lecture: War in Chile and its internal consequences (in Spanish)	Santiago, Chile (online)
Pontificia Universidad Católica de Chile	May 2022
Undergraduate Seminar: Political Violence: Concepts, Causes and Consequences	Zurich, Switzerland
University of Zurich (<i>EG: 4.5 out of 5</i>)	Fall Term 2021
Tutorial: Political Economy (in German)	Zurich, Switzerland
University of Zurich	Spring Term 2018, 2019
Bachelor theses supervision	Madrid, Spain
University Carlos III of Madrid (<i>No. of students: 2</i>)	Spring Term 2026
Bachelor internship supervision	Buenos Aires, Argentina (online)
Universidad Torcuato di Tella (<i>No. of students per round: 2-5</i>)	2023-2026

AWARDS AND GRANTS

- **UC3M Mobility Grant (2026):** Grant for postdoctoral researchers, destined for research stay in McGill University, Fall Semester 2026
- **British Academy Postdoctoral Fellowship Stage 2024-2025:** Reserve list ("application highly recommended and considered fully worthy of award if further funds were available")
- **SAGW Travel Grant (2024)**

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant at Latin American Revolts Database

University of Texas at Austin, University College London

Remote

07/2022-07/2023

Research Assistant at International Conflict Research Group

Department of Humanities, Social and Political Sciences, ETH Zurich

Zurich, Switzerland

05/2018 - 09/2019

Research Assistant at Chair of Political Economy and Development

Department of Political Science, University of Zurich

Zurich, Switzerland

09/2017 - 06/2019

SERVICE TO THE PROFESSION

- Reviewer at the *Journal of Peace Research*, the *Journal of Politics*, *Stosunki Międzynarodowe – International Relations*, the *British Journal of Political Science*, and *International Interactions*
- Discussant and Chair at EPSA 2023, Chair at LASA 2026, discussant at the Zurich Political Economy Seminar Series and Madrid Empirical Social Sciences (MESS) Conference 2025

SKILLS

- **Languages**
 - Spanish (native): fluent in speaking, reading and writing
 - English (C1): fluent in speaking, reading and writing
 - German (C1): fluent in speaking, reading and writing
- **Software:** R, QGIS, LaTeX, Python, STATA